



King County Library System

Board of Trustees Meeting Minutes
Bellevue Library | July 30, 2025, 5pm

Present

KCLS Board

Crystal Goodwin
Jeff Guddat
Harish Kulkarni
Srinu Raghavan
Verna Seal
Lalita Uppala
Laura Valenziano

KCLS Staff

Maria Bassett
Jen Baxter
Angie Benedetti
BJ Colvin
Heidi Daniel
Lisa Fraser
Chase Gallagher
Angie Miraffior
Dominica Myers
Danielle Perry
Cecie Streitman
Donna Zirkle

Motions Approved

1. Board Meeting agenda
2. June 25, 2025 Board meeting minutes
3. Payroll expenditures
4. General Fund expenditures

Call to Order

President Laura Valenziano called the meeting to order at 5:04pm. Verna Seal, Srinu Raghavan, Harish Kulkarni, Jeff Guddat, Lalita Uppala and Crystal Goodwin were in attendance in person. There was quorum.

Approval of Agenda

Verna Seal moved approval of the Board Meeting agenda. Jeff Guddat seconded, and the motion passed unanimously.

Approval of Board Minutes

Lalita Uppala moved approval of the June 25, 2025 Board Meeting minutes. Srinu Raghavan seconded the motion. All voted in favor and the motion passed unanimously.

Public Comment

There was no public comment.

Finance and Facilities Report

Finance and Facilities Director Donna Zirkle presented the monthly Finance report as of the end of June 2025. Year-to-date (YTD) revenues were \$81.4M, against the yearly revenue budget of \$150.6M which was approximately 54%. YTD expenses were \$72.6M, which is 44% of the total expense budget of \$164.6M. CIP expenses YTD at the end of June were \$1.7M accounting for 14% of the total budget of \$12.5M.

At the year's halfway point, both revenue and expenses are tracking as expected. Interest income is stronger than projected. To allow full use of library spaces during the summer reading months, projects are generally in the planning stages during spring and summer; several capital improvement projects are scheduled to begin in the fall.



King County Library System

Board of Trustees Meeting Minutes
Bellevue Library | July 30, 2025, 5pm

Approval of Monthly Expenditures

Crystal Goodwin moved approval of Payroll expenditures for June in the amount of \$3,524,078.35: (6/06) Ck#00202415-00202433; 959198585-959199717; (6/20) Ck#00202434-00202444; 965062942-965064081. **Harish Kulkarni seconded, and the motion passed unanimously.**

Verna Seal moved approval of General Fund #0010 expenditures for April in the amount of \$5,301,750.37: Travel Advances – 1550; (6/12) Ck#1160143-1160290; 5015515-5015517 (6/18) Ck#1160291-1160386; 5015518-5015576 (6/26) Ck#1160387-1160508; 5015577-5015608; (6/30) Ck#1160509-1160577 (7/07) Ck#1160578-1160771; 5015609-5015613. **Jeff Guddat seconded, and the motion passed unanimously.**

The trustees unanimously agreed to add Crystal Goodwin to the Board Development committee for the remainder of the year.

Staff and Director's Reports

Lakeview Region Report

Regional Manager David Frappier was joined by Librarian and Information Services Manager Stephanie Zero and Makerspace Librarian Megan Willan to give an overview of the Lakeview Region which includes Bellevue, Lake Hills, Crossroads and Newport Way Libraries. David talked about the community demographics of the Lakeview region, including race and ethnicity and household income.

The regional presentation included examples of how the region is fulfilling the four different aspects of the KCLS Service Strategy:

Student Success and Lifelong Learning

Stephanie highlighted several initiatives supporting teens, families, and adult learners, including teen advisory boards, the Plaza Comunitaria tutoring program, Talk Time, early literacy programs, and classes and activities at the Bellevue Library Makerspace.

Megan talked about the Makerspace, specifically two recent Makerspace partnerships:

- The Makerspace hosted a mini-hackathon with UW Create and HuskyADAPT to design custom adaptations for people with disabilities.
 - In partnership with HuskyADAPT's Adapt Toys project, participants learned to rewire battery-operated toys with a female jack compatible with a range of accessible switches. The adapted toys were donated to families and organizations serving children with disabilities.
-



King County Library System

Board of Trustees Meeting Minutes
Bellevue Library | July 30, 2025, 5pm

Engaging with Books and Reading

Stephanie highlighted the *One Bellevue, One Book* program, designed to bring the Bellevue community together to read, discuss, and engage with a single book. This year's selection was *We Hereby Refuse: Japanese American Resistance to Wartime Incarceration*, by Frank Abe and Tamiko Nimura. She also noted Bellevue's monthly Chinese book club.

Obtaining Trustworthy Information

Bellevue offers several programs and services to help patrons access reliable information. These include the new Bellevue Community Court and community resource center in partnership with the City of Bellevue. Additional offerings include a welcoming center for immigrants, refugees, and new arrivals; one-on-one ancestry help; and informational tabling at the library.

Making Meaningful Connections

Stephanie highlighted the *Emerging Radiance* art exhibit, presented in partnership with the City of Bellevue. Other programs include Queer Creative Connections, a craft exchange, and the library's award-winning art cart.

Stephanie concluded her presentation with an overview of the Memory Lab, a five-year project funded by the Mellon Foundation. The lab's goal is to record, preserve, and amplify the unique stories of King County community members.

Curiosity Isn't Quiet Ad Campaign

Director of Communications and Marketing Chase Gallagher reported on the Curiosity Isn't Quiet ad campaign. He began by discussing baseline consumer research of KCLS cardholders and non-cardholders conducted in December 2024. The campaign was designed to increase awareness of KCLS among non-library users and inactive cardholders. The media strategy emphasized high impressions for broad visibility, with primary channels including digital video, social media, outdoor advertising, local publications, and radio.

Chase shared results from the campaign's launch stage, which ran from late February through late April. The campaign exceeded benchmarks for both video completion and cost efficiency, delivering 18.6 million impressions. The cost per thousand impressions dropped significantly from \$8.89 in 2024 to \$3.00 in 2025.

He also presented results from the Summer Reading campaign, which outperformed benchmarks as well. From May 1 through June 13, it generated 4.9 million digital impressions.



King County Library System

Board of Trustees Meeting Minutes
Bellevue Library | July 30, 2025, 5pm

Looking ahead, the department plans to launch a new awareness survey in January 2026 and expand media channels to include YouTube.

Equity and Social Impact Department Update

Equity and Social Impact (ESI) Director Dominica Myers provided an update on the department. She began with data about the service area, including population, geography, schools, and incorporated and unincorporated communities. She also shared demographic information such as annual income, percentage of residents who identify as Black, Indigenous and people of color (BIPOC), English language proficiency, and homeownership rates.

Myers reviewed key milestones since the department's inception in 2020. Over nearly five years, ESI has completed several major assessments, including a Diversity, Equity and Inclusion (DEI) Assessment, an Accessibility Audit, and a World Language Community Needs Assessment. These assessments informed two comprehensive plans: the 2023–27 Organizational DEI Plan and the 2024–30 Accessibility Plan.

The ESI team includes nine staff members, among them four coordinators and three specialists. Ongoing areas of emphasis include social impact; accessibility; world language equity; trauma-informed service; and assessment, strategy and training.

Focus areas for 2025-26 include:

- Community listening opportunities
- Heritage and awareness celebrations
- Supports for world language communities
- Social service supports
- Community partnerships
- Support for organizational initiatives

Director's Report

Executive Director Heidi Daniel kept her remarks brief due to time constraints. She referred trustees to her written report and highlighted the upcoming roundtable with U.S. Rep. Kim Schrier, scheduled for the following day at the KCLS Service Center. The discussion will focus on local impacts of federal funding cuts to the Institute of Museum and Library Services. She concluded with a brief discussion of key dashboard items.

Board Committee Reports

There were no Board committee reports.



King County Library System

Board of Trustees Meeting Minutes
Bellevue Library | July 30, 2025, 5pm

Trustees Reports

Trustee Crystal Goodwin provided a brief report on her experience attending a KCLS Foundation Live Pages event. The event featured Susan Lieu, author of *The Manicurist's Daughter*.

Adjournment

Laura Valenziano adjourned the meeting at 6:55pm.

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read 'Laura Valenziano', written over a horizontal line.

Laura Valenziano, President

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read 'Jeff Buddat', written over a horizontal line.

Jeff Buddat, Secretary
